

Top1Movers Shipment Workflow: Inquiry to Closed

A shipment moves from a client's first price request to a closed job in two tracks: sales (inquiry, quotation, conforme) and then a nine-stage shipment job. This guide walks one import shipment end to end, stage by stage, naming who acts, what the screen asks for and what must be true before the job can move on.

As of 30 Sep 2026 · Stakeholder mockup, sample data only

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About this guide

A shipment moves from a client's first price request to a closed job in two tracks: sales (inquiry, quotation, conforme) and then a nine-stage shipment job. This guide walks one import shipment end to end, stage by stage, naming who acts, what the screen asks for and what must be true before the job can move on.

- **For:** stakeholders reviewing the Operations Portal mockup, demo presenters, and UAT testers.
- **Reflects:** the mockup on the `demo` branch as of 30 Sep 2026, including the latest quick fixes (required contact phone and email, date picker for pickup, confirm client payment with proof).
- **How to read it:** each stage section has what happens, who does it, and the gate that must be met to move on. The Quick reference at the end collects every gate in one table.
- All data is sample data. Names, job IDs and amounts are mock.

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Roles

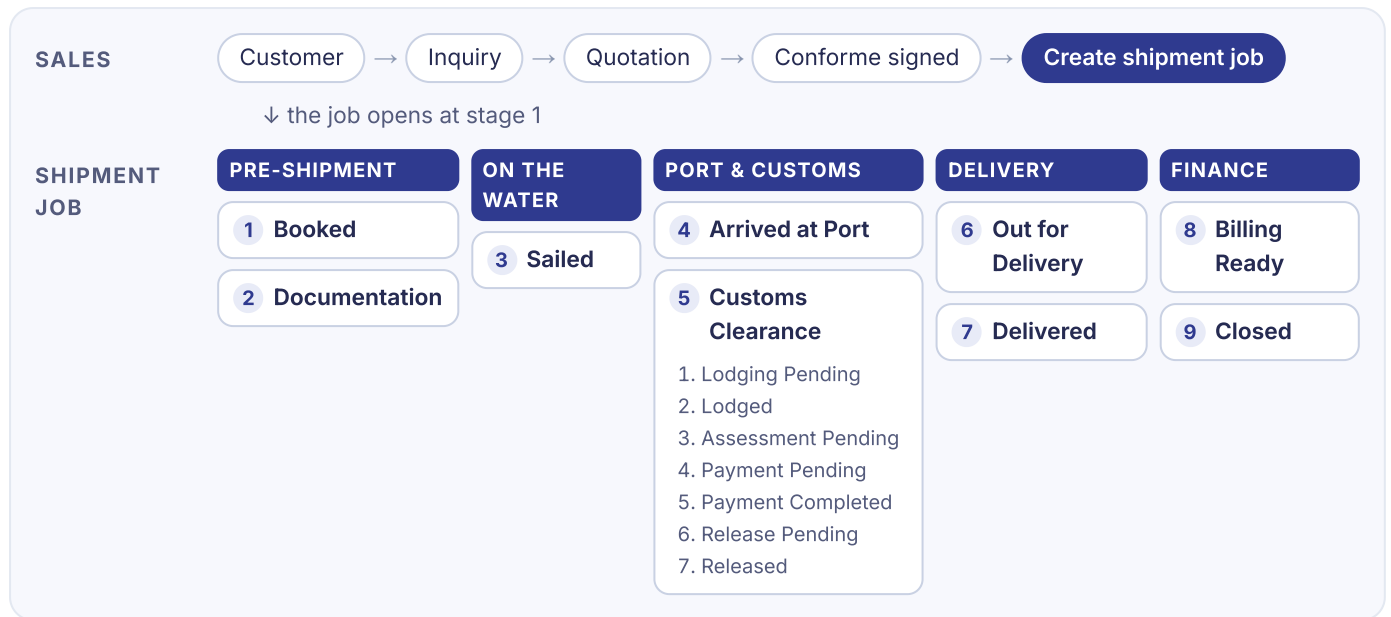
Five roles share the work. The Dispatcher runs the job day to day, the Manager makes the decisions and handles client money, and Finance only receives the finished job.

ROLE	DOES IN THIS WORKFLOW	CANNOT
Dispatcher	Adds customers, registers inquiries, builds quotes, converts to a job, uploads and approves documents, completes tasks, moves stages up to Delivered, confirms the client has paid duties	See or record client money, approve exceptions, mark a job ready for Finance
Warehouse Crew	Works assigned tasks on a phone, confirms delivery with proof, returns the empty container, raises exceptions	See jobs without a task for them, move stages
Manager	Everything the Dispatcher does, plus: records client deposits, decides extra charges, approves exceptions, places and clears customs holds, marks ready for Finance, closes the job	Manage users and access
Admin	Everything a Manager does, plus users and roles	(nothing)
Finance	Reads billing-ready jobs, money and the Billing Summary	Change anything

The client does not sign in. They receive the quotation, sign the conforme, pay deposits and duties, and can follow the shipment on the public tracking page.

The lifecycle at a glance

Sales ends when the inquiry becomes a shipment job. The job then moves through nine stages in order, grouped into five phases. Customs Clearance has seven inner steps of its own.



#	STAGE	MEANING	MOVED ON BY
1	Booked	Booking confirmed with the shipping line	Dispatcher
2	Documentation	Collecting and checking the five shipping documents	Dispatcher
3	Sailed	The vessel has left the origin port	Dispatcher
4	Arrived at Port	The container is at the Philippine port; free storage days are running	Dispatcher
5	Customs Clearance	Lodging the entry, paying duties and getting the goods released	Dispatcher
6	Out for Delivery	Released and on a truck to the consignee	Warehouse Crew or Manager, by confirming delivery
7	Delivered	Received with proof of delivery; the empty container must go back	Manager (Mark ready for Finance)
8	Billing Ready	Money checked and handed to Finance	Manager (Close job)
9	Closed	Nothing left to do	—

Every job page has a **Next step** panel: it shows the gate for the current stage as a checklist, puts the fix next to every unmet line, and offers exactly one primary action. Nobody has to know the rules in advance.

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Winning the work: inquiry to shipment job

A shipment job exists only after the client has signed a quotation. The Dispatcher takes the request from first contact to a job in five steps, and nothing is retyped along the way.

1. **Add the customer** (Customers, then New customer). Company name, contact phone and contact email are required; contact person, city, delivery address and delivery instructions are optional. A "Possible duplicate" warning appears if the name matches an existing customer.
2. **Register the inquiry** from the customer's page (New inquiry). The customer is fixed to the one you came from. Cargo, origin port and final destination are required. Container type, requested pickup (date picker) and delivery address can wait. From the Home page or the Inquiries list, the drawer instead shows a customer dropdown.
3. **Create the quotation** (Create quotation): total in PHP, terms (default Net 30), notes. A revision becomes v2, v3 and so on; earlier versions are kept, and each revision must say what changed.
4. **Record the client's approval (the conforme)**: who approved, date, how (signed PDF, email, in person), optional signed copy.
5. **Create the shipment job**. The drawer lists every detail carried over. The job opens at stage Booked with the five required documents set to missing and the standard task list assigned.

Gate to become a job: shipment details complete (cargo, route, container type, pickup date, delivery address), a quotation sent, and the conforme recorded. A request can be priced before every detail is known, but it cannot become a job until they are.

Declining: an inquiry can be declined at any point with a required reason (for example, "Client chose another forwarder").

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Booked to Arrived at Port

The first four stages get the paperwork right before the goods sail, then track the vessel to the Philippine port. The Dispatcher moves the job through each one from the job page's Next step panel.

1. **Booked**. The booking is confirmed with the shipping line. Gate: vessel and voyage recorded (carried over from conversion). Action: Start documentation.
2. **Documentation**. The five required documents are collected and checked: Commercial Invoice, Packing List, Bill of Lading, Certificate of Origin, Import Permit. Each one is uploaded (Dispatcher, Warehouse Crew, Manager), then reviewed and either approved or rejected with a reason; a rejected document is replaced as a new version. Gate: all five approved, and the task "Verify shipment documents complete" done with a proof file. Action: Confirm vessel sailed.
3. **Sailed**. The vessel has left the origin port. Gate: none beyond open fixes from exceptions. Action: Confirm arrival at port.
4. **Arrived at Port**. The container is at the port and the free storage clock starts (the mockup sets the deadline 5 days out). Every job shows the countdown so port fees are never a surprise. Action: Start customs clearance.

Why documents come first: customs rejects an entry built on wrong paperwork, so documents are settled before the goods sail.

Customs Clearance

Customs is one stage with seven inner steps, and the job cannot leave it until customs has released the goods and a truck is booked. Free storage keeps running throughout, so this is where delays cost money.

STEP	WHAT HAPPENS	GATE TO MOVE ON	WHO
Lodging Pending	The customs entry (official declaration) is prepared	Task "Lodge customs entry" done, with the lodged entry or BOC acknowledgement as proof	Dispatcher
Lodged	Customs has the entry	None	Dispatcher
Assessment Pending	Customs works out the duties	None. Moving on asks who pays the duty: Top1Movers (from the client's deposit) or the client	Dispatcher
Payment Pending	Duties are paid	See below	Dispatcher, Manager
Payment Completed	Paid; customs processes the release	None	Dispatcher
Release Pending	The shipping line issues the delivery order	Task "Secure delivery order" done	Dispatcher
Released	Goods released by customs	Task "Book delivery truck" done. Action: Send out for delivery	Dispatcher

Payment Pending in detail

When the client is paying, the job shows "Waiting on the client" until someone confirms the money is in.

- 1. Client has paid.** Clicking it opens a Confirm client payment drawer with a warning, the customer, contact and duty due. Proof of payment is required: if a Manager already recorded the client's deposit with a slip while the job was waiting, that slip is shown and reused; otherwise the user must upload a bank slip or transfer confirmation. An optional note records how it was confirmed. Only "Yes, client has paid" records it, and the audit log names the proof file.
- 2. Enough client funds.** If the client's deposits do not cover the duty, the gate shows the shortfall and a Manager records the deposit (Add funds received).
- 3. Pay duties and assessment.** The task needs the duty payment receipt. It cannot be marked done while client funds are short. Completing it marks the duty charges as paid.

Lanes and holds

- **Lane** (set from the customs selectivity result): Green is a documents-only light check, Yellow is a document review, Red is a physical inspection and takes longest.
- **Customs hold** (Under inspection or On hold): placed with a note on what customs is waiting on. It freezes the customs steps until a Manager or Admin clears it.

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Out for Delivery and Delivered

A job reaches Delivered only through a confirmed delivery with proof, never by picking a status. That proof is what makes the job billable.

1. **Out for Delivery.** The goods are released and on a truck to the consignee. The free storage clock stops and the free detention clock on the shipping line's container starts (the mockup sets it 5 days out).
2. **Confirm delivery** (Warehouse Crew, Manager or Admin, usually on a phone). The drawer shows the customer's delivery instructions and asks for: who received the goods (required), the delivery date, and a proof of delivery file, such as a photo of the signed receipt (required). A switch reports damaged or incomplete goods with a description.
3. **Delivered.** Confirming moves the job here automatically and completes the "Deliver to consignee" task. The remaining field work is the "Return empty container" task, which stops the detention clock.

If damage was reported, a Manager must resolve it before the job can go to Finance.

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Billing Ready and Closed

Finance receives one clean, checked job instead of chasing people for receipts. Only a Manager or Admin can hand a job to Finance and close it.

Billing checklist (all six must be met before "Mark ready for Finance" works):

- ☐ All tasks done, including the empty container return
- ☐ All documents approved
- ☐ Delivery confirmed with proof, with no unresolved damage
- ☐ No open exceptions
- ☐ Extra charges decided: the client agreed to pay, or Top1Movers absorbs it with a reason
- ☐ At least one charge recorded

Each unmet line has its fix next to it on the job page (Complete task, Decide, Add charge, Resolve damage, or Open the right tab).

1. **Billing Ready.** Marking ready hands the job to Finance, who see it with its money and a printable Billing Summary. The Billing Summary is a handoff, not an invoice.
2. **Closed.** The Manager closes the job. Closing freezes the record; every stage, document, delivery proof and peso stays in the history.

Running alongside every stage

Four things are not stages but apply at any point in the job.

Tasks and proof

The standard task list is created with the job, each task tied to the point in the workflow where it becomes today's work:

TASK	BECOMES DUE AT	PROOF NEEDED	DONE BY
Verify shipment documents complete	Documentation	Yes	Dispatcher
Lodge customs entry	Customs: Lodging Pending	Yes (lodged entry or BOC acknowledgement)	Dispatcher
Pay duties and assessment	Customs: Payment Pending	Yes (duty payment receipt)	Dispatcher
Secure delivery order	Customs: Release Pending	No	Dispatcher
Book delivery truck	Customs: Released	No	Dispatcher
Deliver to consignee	Out for Delivery	Yes (proof of delivery)	Warehouse Crew
Return empty container	Delivered	No	Warehouse Crew

A task that needs proof cannot be marked done without a file. That is what makes the record trustworthy later. Warehouse Crew can only complete their own tasks.

Exceptions

Anyone except Finance can raise an exception when something goes wrong: a category, what happened, impact (Low, Medium, High) and optional evidence. **Raising one freezes the job:** nobody can move it on until a Manager or Admin reviews it.

- **Approve:** the Manager names the fix, who does it and by when. The job unfreezes, and the fix becomes a task with required proof that must be done before the job can leave its stage.
- **Reject:** the Manager must say why it is not a real problem. The job unfreezes.

Client money

Each job keeps a funds ledger, a per-job notebook rather than accounting. Managers and Admins record money in and costs out; Finance can read it; Dispatchers and Warehouse Crew do not see amounts.

- **Add funds received:** amount, date, method, optional bank reference and a deposit slip.
- **Charges:** costs paid for the client are billed back at cost; service fees are Top1Movers' own. A cost that was not in the signed quotation is an extra charge and must be decided (client agreed, or absorbed with a reason) before billing.
- **Funding gap:** when an upcoming cost is not covered by the client's deposits, the job shows the shortfall, and paying duties is blocked until it is covered.

Deadlines and the audit log

- **Free storage** runs while the container is at the port (Arrived at Port and Customs Clearance). **Free detention** runs from Out for Delivery until the empty container is returned. Only one runs at a time, and the job shows a warning when 2 days or fewer remain.
- **Audit log:** every stage change, task, document, exception, hold and money entry is logged with who did it and when. Managers can also override a job's stage directly; that is logged too.

Quick reference

STAGE	GATE TO MOVE ON	REQUIRED PROOF	WHO MOVES IT ON
Inquiry	Details complete, quotation sent, conforme recorded	Signed copy optional	Dispatcher (Create shipment job)
1 Booked	Vessel and voyage recorded	—	Dispatcher
2 Documentation	All 5 documents approved; "Verify shipment documents complete" done	Task proof file	Dispatcher
3 Sailed	No open fixes	—	Dispatcher
4 Arrived at Port	No open fixes	—	Dispatcher
5 Customs: Lodging Pending	"Lodge customs entry" done	Lodged entry or BOC acknowledgement	Dispatcher
5 Customs: Lodged	—	—	Dispatcher
5 Customs: Assessment Pending	Choose who pays the duty	—	Dispatcher
5 Customs: Payment Pending	Client payment confirmed (if client pays); funds cover the duty; "Pay duties and assessment" done	Client proof of payment; duty payment receipt	Dispatcher; Manager records deposits
5 Customs: Payment Completed	—	—	Dispatcher
5 Customs: Release Pending	"Secure delivery order" done	—	Dispatcher
5 Customs: Released	"Book delivery truck" done	—	Dispatcher
6 Out for Delivery	Delivery confirmed	Receiver name + proof of delivery	Warehouse Crew, Manager, Admin
7 Delivered	Billing checklist (6 items) met	—	Manager or Admin
8 Billing Ready	Billing Summary handed to Finance	—	Manager or Admin (Close job)
9 Closed	—	—	—

At any stage: an open exception or a customs hold freezes the job until a Manager or Admin acts.